

Concurrency in Haskell

Haskell's *MVar* is a key building block for concurrency. As we shall see, it allows a mixture of: shared memory concurrency and message passing concurrency.

```
import Control.Concurrent
```

```
forkIO :: IO () -> IO ThreadId
```

Kicks off the computation asynchronously in a new thread; immediately returns the new thread's id. *forkIO* causes a thread to run asynchronously. When *main* ends, the program is terminated even if threads are still running.

MVar a - mutable variable storing a value of type *a*

An *MVar* is either empty (holds no value) or full (holds a value of type *a*).

Create a new *MVar* with a given value:

```
newMVar :: a -> IO (MVar a)
```

Create a new empty *MVar*:

```
newEmptyMVar :: IO (MVar a)
```

Take value from an *MVar*:

```
takeMVar :: MVar a -> IO a
```

Blocks until the *MVar* is full, leaves the *MVar* empty. Yields the value that was in the *MVar*.

Put value into an *MVar*:

```
putMVar :: MVar a -> a -> IO ()
```

Blocks until the *MVar* is empty. Leaves the *MVar* full, containing the given value.

Read current value from *MVar*:

```
readMVar :: MVar a -> IO a
```

Blocks until the *MVar* is full. Yields the current value of the *MVar*, leaving it full.